detrimental to its sovereignty, even if that meant that the deal would fall through.

◆

5 JULY 2021

INDIA | 4,65,897 ACTIVE CASES | 4,08,211 DEATHS | 28.67 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

WORLD | 1,15,16,576 ACTIVE CASES | 40,15,824 DEATHS | 191 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

When we were in the midst of the crisis, over 40 countries sent us prompt aid which included 19 oxygen-generation plants, 11,058 oxygen generators, 13,496 oxygen cylinders, 7,365 ventilators, over 5.3 lakh vials of remdesivir and over 25,000 rapid antigen test kits. Many more who couldn't send help due to domestic requirements, sent us best wishes. This was a classic example of the *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* philosophy that India aspired to propagate. The world came together as a family as the second-most populous country was being attacked by our common enemy. When the time came, India would repay the generosity, surely.

Two months ago, when the CoWIN platform proved that it could hold its ground and truly become an asset, driving the largest vaccination drive in the world, the prime minister expressed to R.S. Sharma on 27 May that the platform should be open sourced and given to as many countries who wish to acquire and use it free of cost. To take this directive forward, on 5 July, a CoWIN conclave was organized since over 50 countries from Central Asia, Latin America and Africa had already expressed desire in using it. In his opening remarks, the prime minister reiterated his stand, 'The biggest lesson from the COVID-19 pandemic is that for humanity and the human cause, we have to work together and move ahead together. We have to learn from each other and guide each other about our best practices.'[3] At the conclave, where India demonstrated how the platform could be adapted to each country's requirements and used accordingly, health and technology experts from across the world were present. Sharma noted in his address that vaccinating 1.3 billion people was no trivial task, and now that we had used the platform to handle over 30 crore registrations,